Hamilton. The documents, he said, proved the NSA was conducting widespread, illegal surveillance of millions of Americans in the United States and abroad, including gathering and keeping records of phone conversations, e-mails, and online activity. He added that he wanted to reveal his identity so he could take responsibility; he did not want anyone else to be blamed.

Greenwald interviewed Snowden for several days, and he wrote five articles that would be published in the British *Guardian* newspaper beginning June 5, 2013—four stories about different NSA surveillance programs and one story revealing Snowden as the leaker.

NATIONAL SECURITY AGENCY

The NSA was established on November 4, 1952, by President Harry S. Truman to decipher coded enemy communications during the Korean War (1950–1953). But NSA-like operations actually began as early as World War I (1914–1918), when the US Army gathered information from foreign radio messages. Then, in the 1940s during World War II (1939–1945), cryptologists, people who use machines to decipher codes, gathered information to help defeat Germany. The agency grew in size and scope, and gradually it became larger than the CIA. With the rise of the Internet, the NSA's activities shifted from cryptography to stopping threats of cyberterrorism, computer hacking, and computer viruses. As of 2012, the NSA had a workforce of approximately 30,000 employees located at its headquarters in Fort George G. Meade, Maryland, and at other sites around the world.[1]

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Edward Snowden: NSA Whistle-Blower, ABDO Publishing Company, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,